MHA ADVOCACY BRIEFING · SHORT VERSION

NOV 3 – NOV 4, 2026

What Michigan's new majority said about health care

What the winners said in election-night speeches and first interviews, and a summary of it. The full 20-page report has every statement and transcript.

9	79	3	28
speeches and press events analyzed	minutes of video transcribed	leaders who addressed health care	statements on health care

01

Summary of what was said

From election night (Nov. 3) through Nov. 4, **6** Democratic leaders appeared on camera in **9** speeches, press events and interviews (**79** minutes of video). Three of them talked about health care: Abdul El-Sayed (21 statements), Debbie Dingell (5) and Jocelyn Benson (2). Winnie Brinks, Curtis Hertel Jr. and Mallory McMorrow did not mention health care.

El-Sayed said the first thing to do is stop the federal Medicaid cuts scheduled for January 2027. He said people who lose Medicaid will end up in emergency rooms, and that he expects some Republicans, especially from rural communities, to support reversing the cuts. He called for Medicare for All, said Blue Cross Blue Shield holds about 85% of Michigan's insurance market, and said insurers should not be able to raise rates by double digits or do stock buybacks.

Dingell said reversing the Medicaid cuts will be "one of the first things" the new U.S. House majority does, along with reinstating the ACA premium tax credit. She described constituents worried about losing Medicaid after receiving letters from the federal government. Benson listed health care with housing, child care and energy as costs her administration will make affordable, and pledged that women and girls will have access to the health care they need. Ranjeev Puri, quoted by the Michigan Advance, said he "watched healthcare be ripped away from our sick."

No leader mentioned hospitals, nurses or reimbursement, and no one named a specific state health bill. Attorney General-elect Eli Savit's victory remarks, as reported by the Michigan Advance and WLNS, did not mention health care.

02

What each leader said

Health statements counted across each leader's appearances on video, Nov. 3–4.

LEADER	HEALTH STATEMENTS	WHAT THEY SAID
AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect	21	Called stopping the January 2027 Medicaid cuts the first priority and Medicare for All the answer on health care. Criticized Blue Cross Blue Shield's market share and rate increases, and called for limits on rate increases and stock buybacks and for breaking up large corporations. Told stories of constituents struggling with insurance and medical costs.
DD **Debbie Dingell** U.S. Rep., MI-6	5	Said reversing the Medicaid cuts and reinstating the ACA premium tax credit will be among the new House majority's first acts. Described constituents afraid of losing Medicaid. Called the health care system "broken."
JB **Jocelyn Benson** Governor-elect	2	Listed health care with housing, child care and energy as costs to make affordable. Pledged that women and girls will have access to the health care they need. Named no specific health policy.
WB **Winnie Brinks** Lieutenant Governor-elect	–	Did not mention health care. Spoke about affordability and working across parties.
CJ **Curtis Hertel Jr.** Michigan Democratic Party Chair	–	Did not mention health care. Rallied supporters and predicted wins across the ticket.
MM **Mallory McMorrow** State Senator	–	Did not mention health care. Spoke about the economy, organizing and the U.S. Senate race.
RP **Ranjeev Puri** House Democratic Leader, likely Speaker	NEWS QUOTE	"I watched healthcare be ripped away from our sick" (election-night watch party, per the Michigan Advance). Named no specific health policy.
DC **Darrin Camilleri** State Senator	NEWS QUOTE	Did not mention health care. His statement was about the expanded Senate Democratic majority (per The Detroit News).
ES **Eli Savit** Attorney General-elect	NEWS QUOTE	Did not mention health care in his Nov. 4 victory remarks. Said he would represent "the people and not the powerful" and "I am going to work for you" (per the Michigan Advance and WLNS). No post-election video found.

03

In their words

Selected health care statements, verbatim. Timestamps open the video at that moment.

▶ 2:25 **Abdul El-Sayed** · Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4

“So, the first most important thing we can do is the worst of this big ugly bill has not yet happened. They purposely pushed it into January of 2027, and that's the Medicaid cuts. We're going to watch tens of thousands of people, right, in in our communities get kicked off their Medicaid roles.”

▶ 2:39 **Abdul El-Sayed** · Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4

“And even if you're not on Medicaid, this still affects you. And let me explain why. Those people still get sick. They still need healthare. and instead of getting it in a primary care office before it's a lot worse and more expensive, they have to go to an emergency room.”

▶ 3:09 **Abdul El-Sayed** · Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4
"So, I actually think that we're going to be able to get some crossover from Republicans, especially in rural communities, okay, who say, you know what, like this is a crazy thing and we need to address it."

▶ 5:18 **Abdul El-Sayed** · Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4
"And these corporations are telling themselves, in particular, DTE and Blue Cross, right? Both of them functional monopolies, right? The attorney general right now is suing Blue Cross Blue Shield because they are basically 85% of our insurance market. There's no real meaningful competition."

▶ 7:40 **Abdul El-Sayed** · Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4
"So, I think that's part of it. I think they should not be able to just raise rates like that. I don't think they should be able to make money handoverfist. I don't think corporations should be able to to to engage in stock buybacks, right?"

▶ 8:06 **Abdul El-Sayed** · Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4
"And then when it comes to healthcare, look, the answer here is Medicare for all. There's no reason in the richest, most powerful country in the world where we're spending our money to buy bombs and tanks for other countries that we can't guarantee healthcare."

▶ 0:30 **Abdul El-Sayed** · Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit
"Medicare for Michigan. We did it."

▶ 16:18 **Abdul El-Sayed** · Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit
"Shouldn't be this hard to see a doctor in the richest, most powerful country in the world."

▶ 1:33 **Debbie Dingell** · Debbie Dingell post-election interview, FOX 2 Detroit
"two women uh had a long talk with me about the letter they received from the federal government on their Medicaid and they didn't know if they were going to have health insurance and they didn't know how to sort through it all and they didn't know if their child got sick they were going to be able to take them to the doctor or afford their medicine."

▶ 3:03 **Debbie Dingell** · Debbie Dingell post-election interview, FOX 2 Detroit
"one of the first things that we are going to do is to reverse the cuts in Medicaid, reverse the cuts in food to help make sure we don't have hungry children and seniors and to address the health care issue"

▶ 3:19 **Debbie Dingell** · Debbie Dingell post-election interview, FOX 2 Detroit
"reinstate the affordable care tax credit until we can figure out what we really need to do to fix a broken health care system."

▶ 2:08 **Debbie Dingell** · Debbie Dingell post-election interview, NBC News
"And I think they're very worried about the cost of groceries, gasoline, about whether they can pay their rent, our broken health care system, and corruption. But we've got to address all of that."

▶ 8:00 **Jocelyn Benson** · Jocelyn Benson and Winnie Brinks transition press conference, Detroit
"We will transform state government to make it efficient and effective and ensure from health care to housing to child care to our energy costs that those costs are affordable for everyone."

▶ 6:21 **Jocelyn Benson** · Jocelyn Benson victory speech, Hudson's Detroit
"As governor and lieutenant governor, who will work together every day to ensure that young girls and women always have access to the health care they need and the rights and freedoms they deserve."

¶ Michigan Advance **Ranjeev Puri** · Election-night speech, Democratic watch party at Hudson's Detroit, Nov. 3
"I watched healthcare be ripped away from our sick. I watched food and benefits taken away from our needy, and I watched tax cuts to billionaire corporations."

No post-election video found for: Eli Savit, Michigan Senate Democrats, Sean McCann, William Lawrence, Christina Hines, Jeremy Moss, Hillary Scholten, Kristen McDonald Rivet, Donavan McKinney, Rashida Tlaib, Gretchen Whitmer.

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